

NON-FINITE VERB

Before knowing about non-finite verbs, we must first understand what finite verbs are.

Finite Verb :

The **finite verb** changes with the person and number of the subject. It has the present or past form. This means a finite verb shows tense. Every sentence must have a finite verb.

The following table shows an example of finite verbs :

Person	Present Tense	
	Singular	Plural
First Person	I eat	We eat
Second Person	You eat	You eat
Third Person	He eats	They eat
	She eats	
	It eats	

The verb **eat** in the above table is a **finite verb** because it changes with the person and number of the subject. When it is used with the third person singular, the verb changes to **eats**.

Non - Finite Verb :

Non finite verbs are those verbs which do not change form with the tense and person or number of the subject. Only by looking at these verbs we cannot tell if the sentence is in present, past or future.

They exist in three forms, namely:

- (a) Gerund form (verb + 'ing')
- (b) Infinitive form (to + verb)
- (c) Participle form : (i) Past participle
(ii) Present participle.
(iii) Perfect participle.

Non finite verbs act as nouns, adjectives or adverbs. It can also combine with finite verbs according to tense.

I. GERUNDS: Gerund Non Finite Verbs :-

'Gerunds' are verbs which **act as nouns to show the performance of actions**.

Example :- seeing, looking, writing, driving etc.

- **Looking** at me, she hid behind the door. (Here, she acts as a subject for looking as well as for hiding.)
- Discovery means **seeing** what everybody has seen and **contemplating** what no one has.
- **Writing** is my passion.
- I like **watching** movies. (Here, watching is acting as a verb for 'movies' and object for 'like'. Thus, gerund plays the dual role of noun as well as object.)

Note :-

Position of 'Gerunds'

1. A gerund can be **used as a subject** at the beginning.

Examples :-

- **Studying** hard is the key to success.
- **Driving** fast can be injurious.

2. A gerund can also be **used as an object** in the sentences **after the verbs**.

Examples :-

- He is considering **joining** Pinnacle for the English Test Series.
- He insisted **on coming** with me.

RULES FOR GERUNDS :-**RULE 1 :-**

Direct gerunds are used after main verbs without anything else. There are some verbs which always take a Gerund.

Avoid, resist, enjoy, resent, stop, start, postpone, defer, prefer, consider, practice, finish, risk, pardon, excuse, forgive, it is no use / good, propose, miss, imagine, mind, detest, can't help, can't bear, regret, anticipate love, like hate, dislike, like, continue etc.

Examples :-

- I **enjoy watching** Cricket matches.
- I **hate getting** up late in the morning.
- I **like working** on this project.

RULE 2 :-

If you want to use a **gerund with a noun or pronoun**, always use the **possessive case of noun or possessive adjective**.

Possessive adjective : **my, our, your, their, her, his, its etc.**

Possessive case of noun: **use of apostrophe ('S)**

Examples :-

- He likes **my working** style.
- We appreciate **mam's teaching** style.
- I recommend **the man's driving** skills.

II. INFINITIVE**Infinitive non-finite verbs**

There are two types of Infinitives:- (a) '**to-infinitive**' and (b) **infinitive without 'to'** (also called '**bare infinitive**' or '**direct infinitive**')

FORMS OF INFINITIVES :- There are four forms of infinitive, each of which has an active and passive form:

1. Simple infinitive :- (To + 1st form of verb)**Examples :-**

- I was glad **to see** her.
- He must **be** very happy.

2. Continuous infinitive :- (to) be -ing form

To talk about an action in progress at a particular time in the past, present, or future.

Examples :-

- I'm glad **to be going there**.
- You must **be kidding**.
- This time next week, I will **be working** in my office.

3. Perfect infinitive :- (to) have + 3rd form of verb**Examples :-**

- I'm glad **to have worked** with you.
- They must **have forgotten** about your good deeds.

4. Perfect continuous infinitive :- (to) have been + -ing form

To express an action that continued for a period of time and is now complete. The focus is on the duration of time.

Examples :-

- I'm glad **to have been living** in Delhi for the last ten years.
- Soon, he'll **have been studying** for three hours.

PASSIVES OF THE INFINITIVES :-

Passive forms are also possible: ("**to + be + Illrd form of verb**")

Examples :-

- Your content has **to be typed**.
- This sonnet must **have been written** by Shakespeare.

search on TG-@freepdfhall

SOME RULES REGARDING USES OF INFINITIVES :-

RULE 3 :- Infinitives function as a **noun, adverb or as an adjective.**

Examples :-

- **To sing** is her passion. ('to sing' is the subject of this sentence acting as a noun)
- There are many places **to visit** in Europe. ('to visit' is an adjective which modifies the noun 'places'.)
- Radha will clear the exam **to set an example**. ('to set' modifies the verb 'clear'. Thus, it is an adverb.)

RULE 4 :- They are in **"to + V₁"** form (but not always).

Examples :-

- I **want to** study abroad.
- She told us **to write** an essay.

RULE 5 :- Infinitive is the basic form of a verb, i.e. all other forms of a verb are created by modifying the infinitive

Examples :-

- Ankit likes **to walk** in the morning. (full infinitive)
- One should **walk** for at least 30 minutes daily to keep one's heart healthy. (bare infinitive)
- Rohit **walks** on the sand in the desert. (walk + s = third person singular form)
- I **walked** 5 miles to reach his college as there was no vehicle available. (walk + ed - past form)
- The circus guy is **walking** barefoot on burning coals. (walk + ing - present participle form)

In the above examples, infinitive has been modified to create other forms of the verb.

RULE 6 :- They can be used as a subject, object and complement.

Examples :-

- To swim is a good exercise. (here 'to swim' is a subject)
- No one wants to die. (here 'to die' is an object)
- He is to go. (here 'to go' is a complement of the verb 'is')

RULE 7 :-

After **ask, advice, allow, command, compel, beg, order, imagine, permit, tell, required, etc.**, we follow the pattern of **'Object + to + 1st form of Verb'**.

Examples :-

- He advised me to go there.
- She ordered me to do the work.

RULE 8 :-

When the verbs **ask, decide, explain, forget, know, show, tell, & understand** are followed by question words such as **where, how, what, who, & when**, then we can use **"To + Infinitive"** with them.

Examples :-

- He asked me how to use the laptop.
- He decided what to do after graduation.

RULE 9 :-

The "to-infinitive" is used frequently with the adverbs **"too and enough"**. These adverbs are followed by the **"to-infinitive"** to explain the reason why the quantity is **excessive, sufficient, or insufficient**.

Examples :-

- He was **too tired to** walk.
- I've had **enough time to** complete the book.

RULES FOR DIRECT/BARE INFINITIVES :-

RULE 10 :-

There are some verbs like **seem, attempt, try, appear, decide, remember, desire, begin, etc.** after which direct infinitive is used.

Examples :-

- They refused to hear me out.
- They appeared to be tired.

RULE 11 :- We use "Bare Infinitives" with modal auxiliaries and verbs like **make, let, see, feel, watch**, notice, hear, bid, behold etc. when used in the active voice.

Examples :-

- I did nothing **but sleep**.
- Did you **see the man go** ?
- I **heard him** laugh.

Note :- When used in Passive Voice, the above verbs take "To + 1st form of verb".

Example :-

- I was **forced to watch** the movie.

RULE 12 :- "Bare Infinitives" is used after- **had better, had rather, had sooner, would rather, sooner than** etc.

Examples :-

- She **had better go** now.
- I **would rather avoid** this topic for a few days.

RULE 13 :- Uses of "Bare Infinitives" with **the question word "Why"**.

Examples :-

- **Why don't we buy** a new book?
- **Why should we wait** until tomorrow?

III. PARTICIPLES :-

Participles are those verbs which can be used as an **adjective, a verb or as a passive form**. It is used to indicate the **past action or the ongoing action**.

Examples :-

- He is **working** in the factory. (Here working is a 'verb') (**Ongoing Action**)
- The **working boy** is my brother. (Here working is an 'adjective')
- The code was **cracked** by the hackers. (**Past Action**)

There are mainly three types of participles :-

(i) Present participle ($V_1 + ing$)

(ii) Past participle (V_3)

(iii) Perfect participle (having + V_3)

(i) Present participle :- It expresses an action going on at the time of speaking. **The present participle ends in '-ing'.**

Examples :-

- A **laughing** man is stronger than a **crying** one. (Here, laughing and crying are adjectives.)
- After **boiling** water, I kept it aside to cool it.

(ii) Past participle :- To show completion of one action before another, past participle is used. Here the second action started as the result. It is also used in making the **passive voice**. The past participle usually ends in "**-ed, -d, -t, -en or -n.**"

Structure for Passive Voice: Verb ('To be') + past participle.

Examples :-

- **Exhausted** by the long walk she decided to go to sleep.
- **Deceived** by his best friend, he was left in the lurch.
- The meeting **was called off**. (**Passive Voice**)

(iii) Perfect participle :- It expresses an action that is just finished in the past. It tells about happening of one action after the other i.e. second action started after the first action had finished.

Structure: Having + past participle

Examples :-

- **Having eaten** the entire cake, she left silently.
- **Having heard** about the earthquake, they rushed quickly out of the building.

PARTICIPLE CLAUSES :- We can use a participle clause when the participle and the verb in the main clause have the same subject.

Examples :-

- Feeling tired, I had a nap.
- Having seen the film before, I didn't want to go with them to the Theatre.

The subject of '**feeling tired**' and '**I had**' are the same, so we can use a participle clause.

These types of clauses don't have a specific tense. The tense is decided by the tense of the verb of the main clause. They are more used in written texts than in spoken language. They add more detail and meaning to the sentences.

Practice Exercise

Directions :- In these questions, read each sentence to find out whether there is any error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer, if there is no error the answer is (d). (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.)

- Q.1. (a) Mom is accustomed /(b) to drink tea /(c) in the morning /(d) no error.
- Q.2. (a) There is no chance of /(b) pass the interview without /(c) preparing thoroughly /(d) no error.
- Q.3. (a) They are given to /(b) procrastinated when it /(c) comes to assignments /(d) no error.
- Q.4. (a) I am used to /(b) taking long /(c) walks in the evening /(d) no error.
- Q.5. (a) They object to /(b) smoke in the /(c) office premises /(d) no error.
- Q.6. (a) The teacher made /(b) her students to practice /(c) their grammar exercises. /(d) no error.
- Q.7. (a) Missing the bus, /(b) they had to find an /(c) alternative mode of transportation /(d) no error.
- Q.8. (a) Exciting by the /(b) news, she shared /(c) it with her friends /(d) no error.
- Q.9. (a) The ran child /(b) caught the /(c) ball effortlessly /(d) no error.
- Q.10. (a) She decided /(b) to pursue a /(c) career in medicine /(d) no error.
- Q.11. (a) The problem appears /(b) being more complicated /(c) than we initially thought /(d) no error.
- Q.12. (a) They watched /(b) the sun rising /(c) over the horizon /(d) no error.
- Q.13. (a) They let /(b) us to go home /(c) early today /(d) no error.
- Q.14. (a) We would rather /(b) walking to the park /(c) than take the bus /(d) no error.
- Q.15. (a) The teacher compelled /(b) the students for completing the /(c) assignment by the end of the day /(d) no error.
- Q.16. (a) The coach ordered the /(b) team to practice harder /(c) for the upcoming match /(d) no error.
- Q.17. (a) The traffic was too /(b) congested for making it /(c) to the airport on time /(d) no error.
- Q.18. (a) Our team winning /(b) streak continued for /(c) the entire season /(d) no error.
- Q.19. (a) During the summer vacation /(b) they plan to spend time /(c) traveling to different countries /(d) no error.
- Q.20. (a) Being a skilled programmer, /(b) she effortlessly solved the /(c) complex coding issues. /(d) no error.
- Q.21. (a) Being a chilly evening, /(b) they gathered around /(c) the fireplace for warmth /(d) no error.
- Q.22. (a) He is given /(b) to exaggerating /(c) folk stories /(d) no error.
- Q.23. (a) In addition to /(b) cook, she /(c) enjoys baking desserts /(d) no error.
- Q.24. (a) Traveling to many countries, /(b) Maria decided to write a book /(c) about her experiences and adventures /(d) no error.

- Q.25. (a) Being a misty morning, / (b) the landscape had / (c) a mystical feel to it / (d) no error.
- Q.26. (a) She went there / (b) with a view to / (c) survey the entire procedure / (d) no error.
- Q.27. (a) Children visiting the park / (b) are amused at the monkeys / (c) play in the cages. / (d) no error.
- Q.28. (a) I regret informing you / (b) that your application / (c) has been refused. / (d) no error.
- Q.29. (a) She made me / (b) to do / (c) work against her wishes. / (d) no error.
- Q.30. (a) Mohit does not / (b) know to swim, so / (c) he is afraid of water. / (d) no error.
- Q.31. (a) After discuss the matter for an hour / (b) the committee adjourned / (c) without having reached any decision. / (d) no error.
- Q.32. (a) Being a cold morning, (b) I decided not to go / (c) for my morning walk. / (d) no error.
- Q.33. (a) I am looking / (b) forward to / (c) meet you soon. / (d) no error.
- Q.34. (a) Do you mind / (b) help me in / (c) completing this book. / (d) no error.
- Q.35. (a) I can hear them / (b) talking but nobody / (c) is coming to opening the door. / (d) no error.
- Q.36. (a) Instead of / (b) to buy books, you should / (c) borrow them from the library. / (d) no error.
- Q.37. (a) Her only motive / (b) was to finding the / (c) truth and to follow it. / (d) no error.
- Q.38. (a) The doctor has refused to / (b) gave them an appointment today / (c) because he has another meeting scheduled. / (d) no error.
- Q.39. (a) You had better worked / (b) harder if you want / (c) to get a government job. / (d) no error.
- Q.40. (a) Being a cold morning / (b) I decided not to go for / (c) morning walk. / (d) no error.

ANSWERS WITH EXPLANATION :-

- Sol.1.(b) Replace "drink" with "drinking". A gerund is used after "accustomed to".
- Sol.2.(b) Replace "pass" with "passing". If a verb is used after a preposition, it should be in gerund form.
- Sol.3.(b) Replace "procrastinates" with "procrastinating". There are some phrases like "given to, accustomed to, prone to etc." which take gerunds just after them.
- Sol.4.(d) no error. When a verb is used before "used to", a gerund is used after 'used to'.
- Sol.5.(b) Replace "smoke" with "smoking". The phrase "object to" takes a gerund with it.
- Sol.6.(b) Replace "to practice" with "practice". We use bare infinitive with verbs like - make, let, see, feel, watch, notice, hear, bid, behold, etc.
- Sol.7.(a) Replace "missing" with "having missed". When the second action starts just after finishing the first action, Perfect participle (having + V₃) is used.
- Sol.8.(a) Replace "exciting" with "excited". To show completion of one action before another, past participle is used.
- Sol.9.(a) Replace "ran" with "running". Present participle (V₁ + ing) is used to show an action going on at the time of speaking.
- Sol.10.(d) no error. After the verb "decide", a direct infinitive is used.
- Sol.11.(b) Replace "being" with "to be". A direct infinitive is used after the verb "appear".
- Sol.12.(d) No error. We can use present participle(-ing verb) or bare infinitive(V₁) after verbs of sensation like watch, see, hear, etc.
- Sol.13.(a) Replace 'to go' with "go". With the verbs like "let/make/bid", a bare infinitive is used.

Sol.14.(b) Replace "walking" with "walk". With "would rather/had better/ had rather", the bare infinitive is used.

Sol.15.(b) Replace "for completing" with "to complete". With the words "compel/command/allow/request", the pattern "Object + to + 1st form of Verb" is used.

Sol.16.(d) no error.

Sol.17.(b) Replace "for making" with "to make". With "too and enough", to-infinitive is used.

Sol.18.(a) Replace team with team's. If a gerund is used with a noun or pronoun, always use the possessive case of the noun and possessive adjective.

Sol.19.(d) no error.

Sol.20.(d) no error.

Sol.21.(a) Add "it" before being. Here, the subject of the participle clause and main clause is not the same.

Sol.22.(d) no error. A gerund is used with "given to".

Sol.23.(b) Replace "cook" with "cooking". If a verb comes with "in addition to", "V₁ + ing" is used.

Sol.24.(a) Replace "traveling" with "having traveled". When a second action starts after the first action has finished, a perfect participle (having + V₃) is used.

Sol.25.(a) Add "it" before 'being' as an introductory subject. Here, the subject of the participle clause and main clause is not the same.

Sol.26.(c) 'Survey' will be replaced by 'Surveying'. 'Gerund' is used after the phrase 'with a view to'.

Sol.27.(c) 'Play' will be replaced by 'Playing'. Present participle(-ing form of the verb) is used to show two actions happening at the same time.

Sol.28.(a) 'Informing' will be replaced by 'to inform'. Gerund is used after the verb 'regret'.

Sol.29.(b) Remove 'to' in the sentence. Bare infinitive is used after the verbs such as "let, bid, make".

Sol.30.(b) 'know to swim' will be replaced by 'how to swim'. We use the expression "how to + V₁" when we talk about knowing, learning or teaching the way of doing something.

Sol.31.(a) 'discuss the matter' will be replaced by 'having discussed the matter'. When the second action starts just after finishing the first action, Perfect participle (having + V₃) is used.

Sol.32.(a) Add 'it' before 'being'. Here, the subject of the participle clause and main clause is not the same.

Sol.33.(c) 'looking forward to meet' will be replaced by 'looking forward to meeting you'. Gerund is used after the phrase 'looking forward to'.

Sol.34.(b) 'help me' will be replaced by 'helping me'. 'Gerund' is used after the verb 'mind'.

Sol.35.(c) 'opening the door' will be replaced by 'open the door'. The first form of the verb is used after the preposition 'to'.

Sol.36.(b) 'to buy' will be replaced by 'buying'. We use a gerund after any preposition.

Sol.37.(b) 'finding' will be replaced by 'find'. The first form of the verb is used after the preposition 'to'.

Sol.38.(b) 'gave' will be replaced by 'give'. Infinitive (to + V₁) is used after the verb 'refuse'.

Sol.39.(a) 'worked' will be replaced by 'work'. The first form of the verb is used after 'had better'.

Sol.40.(a) 'being a cold morning' will be replaced by 'It being a cold morning'. Here, the subject of the participle clause and the main clause is not the same.